PART I - SHORT NOTES

Q1. (1)

Nikolai Gogol uses a narrative style that combines realism, humour, satire, irony, and the supernatural.
The story is written in the third person. The narrator knows the characters and describes their thoughts and feelings. Realistic details present Akaki's life and the social conditions of Russia, so the story remains believable.
Satire criticises government offices, bureaucracy, and the pride of officials. Humour is used to expose serious social problems. Irony is important: Akaki finally owns a new overcoat, but he loses it on the same day. His greatest happiness becomes the cause of his greatest sorrow.
The story ends with a supernatural element. Akaki's ghost wanders the streets, which creates mystery and stands for justice. The overcoat itself is a symbol of hope, dignity, protection, and self-respect. The language is simple, and it mixes humour with sadness.

Q1. (2)

The attack on Mudli is a turning point in Kirubunkal. It brings fear and sadness to the village, and it changes the lives of his family and neighbours.
Seena starts a secret romance with Vimli, the daughter of Chandranna. Chandranna catches them, beats Seena, and drags his daughter away. Seena collapses near Kirubunkal. Mudli finds him half-dead and takes him home. That same night, Chandranna and his men attack Mudli and beat him to death.
Officially, people say Mudli died of disease during an epidemic. He is buried quickly. The attack shows that even a village can be violent, and it reminds the reader of the value of peace and mutual respect.

Q1. (3)

The cart driver reflects the caste discrimination of Ambedkar's childhood. At Masur railway station, Ambedkar and the other children wanted a bullock cart to Goregaon. The drivers refused because the children were Mahars. They were ready to pay double the fare, but the drivers believed that carrying untouchables would pollute them.
One driver agreed on a condition. The children had to drive the cart, and he would walk beside it. They accepted, because they had no other way to reach their father. In the darkness they became frightened and kept asking how far Goregaon was. He told them they would reach soon.
After several hours they reached a toll collector's hut. The driver told them to rest there. They could not get water and spent the night without eating. The next morning he returned, they started at eight o'clock, and they reached Goregaon. His actions show how untouchability made even ordinary travel difficult for children.

Q1. (4)

Water is a sign of social inequality in On the Way to Goregaon. On the way from Masur, the children were hungry. They had brought food, but they needed water before they could eat it. Near a stream, the water was dirty and not fit to drink. At the toll collector's hut they hoped for food and water. On the cartman's advice they pretended to be Muslims, but the toll collector still refused them water. Their caste stood in the way. They had food and still had to stay hungry.
Ambedkar saw that caste discrimination was not limited to social relationships. It reached a basic need such as drinking water. The incident shows the denial of a basic human right.

PART I - LONG ANSWERS

Q2. (1)

Nikolai Gogol mixes realism with satire and the grotesque. His characters often look unusual, but they stand for deeper truths about human life. Akaki Akakievich seems strange and humorous at first. Gogol then shows his innocence, loneliness, and humanity.
Akaki lives an unusual life. He has no interest in entertainment, wealth, or social status. His only happiness is copying official documents. He rarely speaks, except when it is necessary. He is shy and quiet, and he avoids arguments. This simple nature makes him look strange.
He is completely devoted to his work. Even after office hours he enjoys copying documents at home. His appearance is also odd. He wears old clothes, walks quietly, and pays little attention to how he looks. His colleagues laugh at him because he never answers with anger. He bears the insults in silence and goes on with his work.
The great change in his life is the dream of a new overcoat. His excitement over such a simple thing may seem unusual, but it shows the hardship of a poor man's life. After his death, his ghost wanders the streets and steals overcoats. That supernatural change adds another grotesque element.
Although he appears strange, he is kind, honest, hardworking, and innocent. He never harms anyone. Gogol uses this unusual personality to criticise a society that laughs at the weak instead of helping them.

Q2. (2)

In Kirubunkal, Ravikumar Neha shows the oral tradition of Karnataka. Stories connect generations and preserve culture. Hirikateyajji, the elderly storyteller, is one of the most memorable characters.
Tales travel mainly through oral tradition. Grandparents tell stories to children. Parents share stories with their families. Storytellers narrate tales at village gatherings and festivals. Travellers carry stories from one place to another. As a story moves from one generation to the next, small changes are added, but the main message remains. In this way folktales survive for hundreds of years. They are not only entertainment. They preserve history, culture, values, and collective memory.
Hirikateyajji is an old woman who knows many ancient stories. She is the guardian of traditional knowledge. Her stories hold imagination, village history, beliefs, heroes, and moral lessons. She tells them naturally, as elders have done for centuries. Through her, children learn about their ancestors and their cultural traditions. She stands for the living memory of the village. Even while modern life changes quickly, her stories continue to inspire people. She reminds them that culture survives only when stories are remembered and shared.
She is the voice of tradition. She connects the past with the present, and her storytelling protects the heritage of the community. Oral literature is as valuable as written literature. Kirubunkal reminds the reader that stories are the true treasure of a society.

Q2. (3)

Dr. B. R. Ambedkar's journey to Goregaon is one of the most important incidents in On the Way to Goregaon. It became a painful experience that exposed him to untouchability.
During his childhood, Ambedkar and his siblings were living away from their father. Their father, Ramji Sakpal, was working at Koregaon. The children were eager to meet him during their holidays. Their father had been informed about the visit and was expected to receive them at the railway station. They were excited because they had not seen him for some time.
They dressed in good clothes and started by train. They carried their luggage and provisions for the journey. They were happy

and expected a pleasant reunion with their father. An unexpected problem occurred. Their father had not received the letter informing him of their arrival. His servant had hidden it. He was not at the railway station to receive them.
When they reached Masur railway station, they were alone in an unfamiliar place. They had to arrange transport to Goregaon. A journey begun in happiness became a turning point. The children belonged to the Mahar community, which was treated as untouchable. The journey exposed young Ambedkar to caste discrimination and to the injustice faced by oppressed people.

PART II - WRITING SKILLS

Q3. (1)

TEXTILE SHOP
Chitradurga - 577501
1 October 2026
The Sales Manager
Ready-made Garments
Dear Sir,
Sub: Enquiry for readymade garments for children.
I am the proprietor of a textile shop. I wish to open a separate section for children, and I want to purchase a stock of readymade garments for kids. Please send your latest catalogue and quote for the following.

1. The varieties you supply, such as shirts, frocks, shorts, and baby wear, with the sizes and colours.
2. The price of each item, and any trade discount.
3. The cloth, the quality, and any guarantee.
4. The mode of payment, the time needed for supply, and the transport charges.

I will place an order only after I receive your catalogue and quotation. Please reply within a week.
Thank you.
Yours faithfully,
Proprietor

Q3. (2)

BHADRAVATHI PAPER MILLS
D. V. G. Road, Industrial Area, Bhadravathi - 560002
10 October 2026
The Proprietor
Chethan Publishers
Mysore
Dear Sir,
Sub: Quotation for printing paper.
Ref: Your letter asking for a quotation.
Thank you for your letter. We are pleased to quote for the paper in our stock. Samples are enclosed.

Paper	Pack	Price (Rs.)
Map litho, 70 gsm	Ream	280
Cream wove, 60 gsm	Ream	240
Art paper, 130 gsm	Ream	420
Ivory card	100 sheets	350

1. Discount: 10 percent on an order above Rs. 25,000.
2. Delivery: within 7 working days of a confirmed order. Carriage is paid if the order is above Rs. 25,000.
3. Payment: by online transfer within 15 days of the invoice.
4. This quotation is valid for 30 days.

Please send your order if the terms suit you.
Thank you.
Yours faithfully,
Sales Manager

Q3. (3)

GENERAL STORES
Station Road, Dharwad
18 October 2026
The Manager
Bhuvi Grain Merchants
Dharwad
Dear Sir,
Sub: Order for grocery.
Please supply the following grocery at the prices in your current list.

Item	Quantity
Rice	500 kg
Wheat	400 kg
Toor dal	100 kg
Sugar	200 kg
Groundnut oil	50 litres

1. Payment: online transfer within 15 days of the invoice.
2. Delivery: please dispatch the goods within 7 working days to the address above.
3. Please pack the goods securely and confirm the dispatch.

Thank you.
Yours faithfully,
Proprietor

Q3. (4)

NEELKAMAL FURNITURE
No. 342, Nehru Road, Mumbai - 400022
25 June 2025
Sai Garden Dhaba
Near Shamanur, Bypass Road
Davanagere - 577005
Dear Sir,
Sub: Reply to your complaint about furniture of inferior quality.
Ref: Your letter No. 81/SGB/2025 dated 20 June 2025.
We thank you for your letter of 20 June 2025 and for bringing your concern to our attention. We sincerely apologise for the inconvenience caused by the goods of inferior quality supplied to you.
We have investigated the matter. The report received today shows that an error occurred in filling your order for 100 garden chairs, against your order No. 124/OMGH/2025 dated 10 June 2025. The chairs sent to you were meant for a different customer. Through an oversight, they were sent to you.
We regret the mistake. We have already sent the replacement by passenger train. Please return the chairs you received, at our cost.
We value your business. Additional care will be taken in future so that this mistake is not repeated.
Thank you.
Yours faithfully,
Sales Manager

Q3. (5)

MALNAD FOOTWEARS
No. 328, Near Gopi Circle, Nehru Road, Shivamogga - 577201
20 March 2026
Dear Customer,
Sub: Our new footwear for the monsoon.
Are you worried about the coming rainy season, and about walking on streets in a continuous downpour? You need not be troubled. Malnad Footwears is with you.
Shoes made of poor rubber are not suitable for the rains. They can pinch, and they can cause trouble. We have introduced Rainy Raja and Baarish Beauty for the monsoon. They are made of strong but soft rubber, and the sole is designed for a firm and comfortable step. Rainy Raja is for men. Baarish Beauty is for women.
These shoes are available in various sizes and colours. The prices range from Rs. 300 to Rs. 600. The illustrated catalogue shows the models. They are available at all the leading shops. A catalogue is enclosed.

Thank you.
Yours faithfully,
Proprietor

Q3. (6)

1. **Blockchain:** A blockchain is used in cryptocurrency. It is a continuously growing list of records called blocks, linked and secured by cryptography. Each block contains a set of verified transactions. Once a transaction is recorded, it is virtually impossible to alter.
2. **CIBIL:** CIBIL (Credit Information Bureau (India) Limited) score is another name for a credit score. It is a three-digit number from 300 to 900 that reflects a person's creditworthiness. It summarises past loan repayments, credit card use, and other borrowing. A higher score means a lower risk for lenders.
3. **Demat account:** A dematerialised account. It is an electronic account that holds securities such as shares, bonds, mutual funds, government securities, and exchange traded funds in digital form. A bank account holds money. A demat account holds securities.
4. **Bullion:** Gold or silver in the form of mass or bars.
5. **Dividend:** The share of profits given to the shareholders.